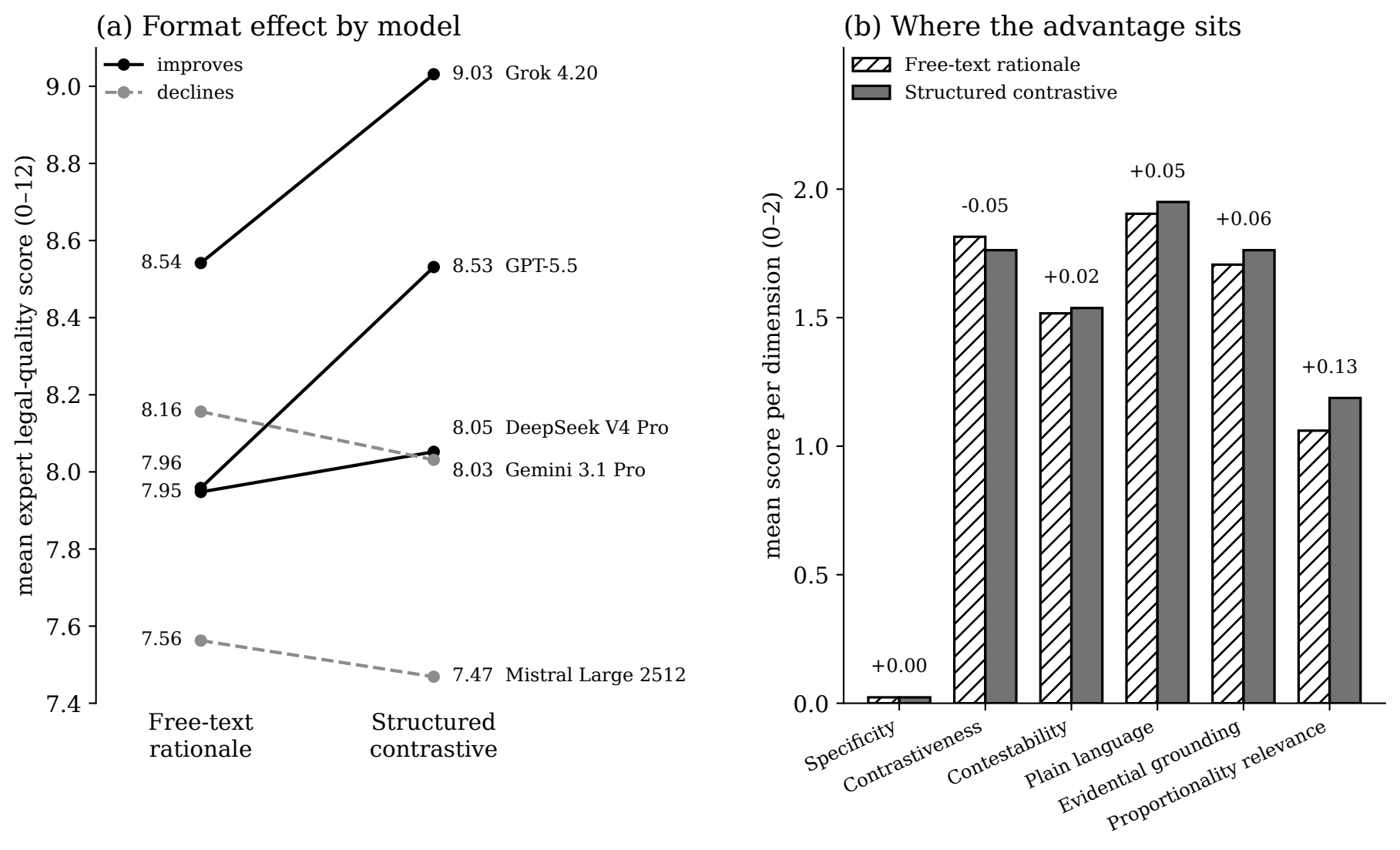
(a) Format effect by model
improves
declines
mean expert legal-quality score (0–12)
9.0
8.8
8.6
8.4
8.2
8.0
7.8
7.6
7.4
9.03 Grok 4.20
8.54
8.53 GPT-5.5
8.16
8.05 DeepSeek V4 Pro
7.96
8.03 Gemini 3.1 Pro
7.95
7.56
7.47 Mistral Large 2512
Free-text rationale
Structured contrastive
(b) Where the advantage sits
Free-text rationale
Structured contrastive
mean score per dimension (0–2)
2.0
1.5
1.0
0.5
0.0
+0.00
-0.05
+0.02
+0.05
+0.06
+0.13
Specificity
Contrastiveness
Contestability
Plain language
Evidential grounding
Proportionality relevance